

Wicked Never Rest

(Lord Koss's POV)

Two thousand years.

That is the precise duration of my existence since I was first birthed into this world—roughly the same era when Lord First descended for his second reincarnation. Since then, I have watched the world unravel into a tapestry of absurdity. I have seen civilizations abandon mana for "illogical gifts" like technology. I have seen nations erect barriers to reject magic, only to crumble from within due to their own entropy.

But never, in two millennia, have I tasted fear this condensed.

It wasn't a fleeting panic; it was a heavy, atmospheric pressure that lingered over the entire planet. It was the gravity of a single existence. He had returned.

I sat in my obsidian carriage, swirling a glass of synthetic blood—a poor substitute, but necessary for diplomatic travel. Outside, the barren landscape of the borderlands rushed by us. We, the Vampire Faction, were preparing for war. For centuries, we had been pressured into passivity, forced to bow as the "Dictatorship of Peace" grew powerful.

No longer.

With the First Hero back on the throne, we didn't need to handle the trilateral balance of power. We could now decide the fate of the world unilaterally.

"Pathetic," I murmured, looking out the window at a distant Elven settlement.

The elves were clinging to hope, praying we wouldn't fight. But logic dictated otherwise. Lord First had provided the blueprints for weapons of mass destruction—Mana Cannons that required immense mana density to fire. Vampires were warriors; we belonged on the battlefield, tearing throats. We couldn't waste our reserves powering artillery.

That was what the elves were for.

If we went to war, the elves wouldn't be allies; they would be bio-mana capacitors. We would hook them up to the machines, draining their life force to fuel our conquest until they were dry husks. It was poetically pathetic, really.

The carriage hit a bump, spilling a drop of my drink. I frowned, reaching for a napkin, when—

*Buzz.*

The shadows in the corner of the carriage flickered. It wasn't a trick of the light. The darkness itself was vibrating at a high frequency.

"What is happening?" I muttered, setting the glass down.

I swiped the air, opening my Advanced Index of Magic. My Unique Title, [Traveler of Shadows], granted me absolute awareness of any spatial distortion within a hundred-mile radius.

A warning rune flashed red.

[ANOMALY DETECTED: SPATIAL TEAR // CLASS: DIVINE]

"Impossible," I hissed.

Teleportation anomalies of this magnitude were usually restricted to the unstable mana zones of the Infinite Desert. But I was currently crossing the border into the Holy Kingdom, a place protected by layers of divine barriers that prevented unauthorized warping.

This wasn't just someone traveling from Point A to Point B.

The readings on my Index spiked off the chart. The sheer magnitude of mana wasn't "moving"—it was *asserting* itself. It felt less like a teleportation spell and more like a god deciding to simply exist in a new location, forcing the universe to accommodate the displacement.

"Driver! Halt!" I shouted.

Before the driver could respond, the horizon ahead lit up.

A blinding Blue Glow erupted in the sky, turning the night into a terrifying mockery of noon. It wasn't fire; it was pure, condensed information—a tear in the fabric of reality that screamed of something alien and ancient.

My shadow sense screamed. The pressure was crushing, like the ocean dropping onto a single point.

"What in the name of the First is th—"

[RADIO SILENCE]

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(Sana's POV)

*Snap.*

The freezing snow of Mount Everest was gone. The biting cold of Earth was replaced instantly by the humid, mana-dense air of the Holy Kingdom.

I stood in the middle of a cobblestone street, the afterglow of my Omnipresence fading from a brilliant blue to nothingness. The transition was flawless. I hadn't just moved my

body; I had moved my *concept*. It is a much easier thing to do than to explain—re-writing your coordinates in the universal source code rather than physically traversing the distance.

Around me, the bustling market had frozen. Merchants dropped their baskets. A child let go of a balloon. They stared at me with pure shock. I was, after all, their Goddess, and deities rarely appear next to a vegetable stand on a random Tuesday.

An envoy of guards rushed forward, their armor clanking. They stopped ten meters away, weapons raised but shaking, confused about whether to bow or attack.

I didn't raise my voice. I simply modulated the air pressure around me to carry my words.

"Guards. Take me to the Archbishop."

The captain of the guard stammered, his spear tip wavering. "L-Lady Sana? Is it truly...?"

I smiled at them—a benevolent, terrifying smile. "Don't worry. We won't need weapons anymore. The peace will remain."

Realizing that mass hysteria was inefficient and not worth the dramatics, I decided to skip the procession.

"Actually, never mind," I whispered.

I warped the space around me, folding the distance between the market and the castle into a single point.

*Step.*

I was inside the Royal Throne Room. It was empty, pristine, and silent—kept vacant out of respect for my absence. Dust motes danced in the light of the stained-glass windows.

"Time to work," I said.

I channeled my mana, not into a spell, but into a Resonance Wave. I struck the heavy mana-bell hanging in the tower—not physically, but by vibrating the air inside it.

*GONG.*

The sound didn't just ring; it rippled through the soul of every high-ranking official in the capital.

Within moments, the doors burst open. The Archbishops, ministers of various affairs, and the high council stumbled in, breathless and terrified by the summons.

I sat on the throne, crossing my legs, looking down at the men who ran my kingdom.

"Welcome," I said, my voice echoing with finality. "We are going to plan a meeting."

This was the start. It was the only way to meet Charlie on equal terms. If I approached him directly, his Chrono Destinatus—the passive skill that preserves his timeline—would view me as a threat to his mental state and block me. But if I approached him politically... if I approached him as a fellow ruler...

Fate would have no choice but to let the story continue.